MX49/MX61 PERFORMANCE EDITOR

Thank you for using the MX Performance Editor!

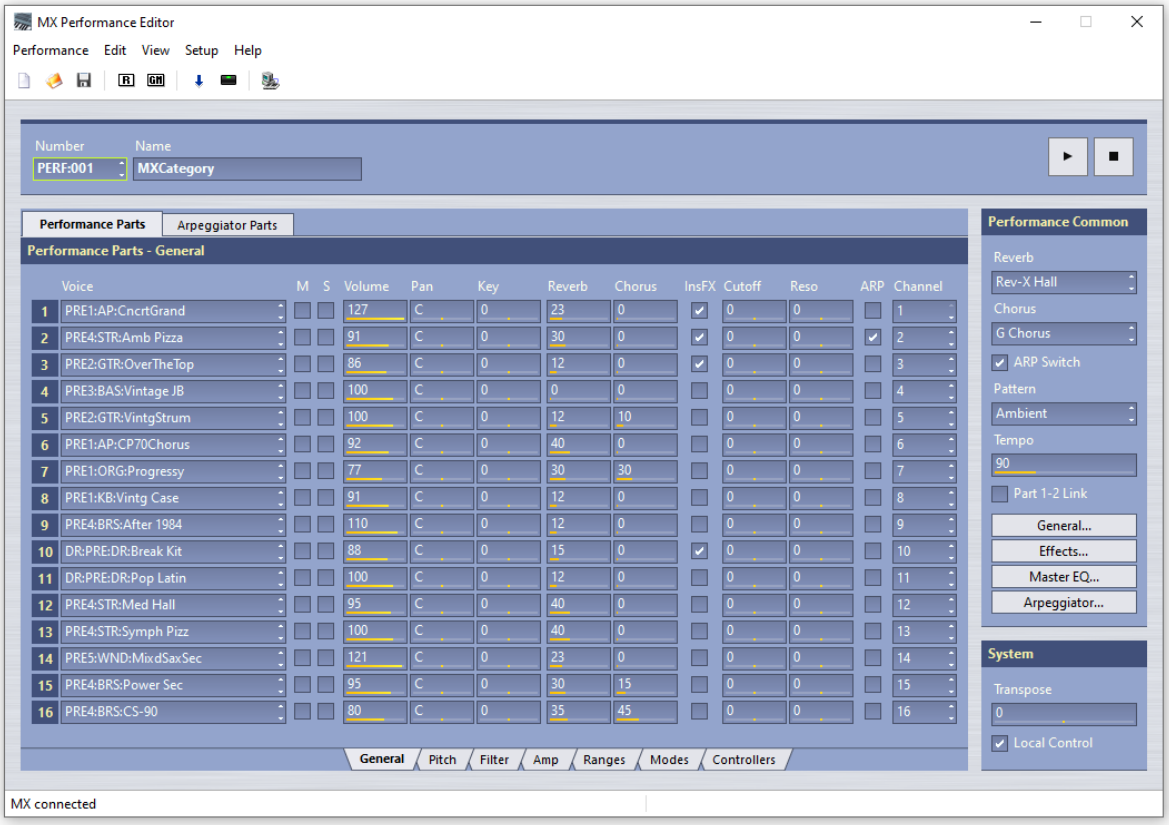
This is a powerful and easy to use editor that will help you get the most out of your MX49/MX61 Synth's Performance Mode.

Key features include:

- Full performance common and part parameters editing in a compact intuitive user interface.
- Allows quick selection of patches from menus grouped by bank or by category. Supports searching of patches by name.
- Supports copy and paste functions to transfer part and effects settings across different Performances.
- Voice Copier utility: a voice can be copied to a Performance part together with all its original parameters, so that it sounds in Performance mode exactly as it sounded in voice mode.
- Supports Voice and Drum Kit Editing for all Performance parts!
- Loads and saves Performances to files together with the User Voices they are using!
- Reads voice names of user banks directly from the synthesizer.
- Reveals the system exclusive message for every tweakable parameter.
- Supports MIDI input from additional MIDI controller for more convenient control.
- Supports MIDI output to one auxiliary tone generator (MIDI thru).
- Full accessibility for VIM users! Every parameter is readable by screen reading software! Edit controls respond to numeric or text data entries!
- Imports and Exports Performances to files.
- Can be opened automatically from a DAW with the use of the 'MX Sync' plugin
- Can save User Voices (used by the Performance) to a file using the Total Librarian engine!
- Can load Total Librarian files to send to the synth the User Voices required for the Performance!
- Phrase recorder: You can record a phrase and listen to it looping while you are editing your Performances!

Main Screen

The application's main window contains three main sections:



Performance Common
Here you can edit the common parameters of the currently selected Performance. The most common ones (Reverb, Chorus, Volume, Local Control etc) appear in the main screen. The others are grouped in categories and can be viewed by pressing the appropriate button (General, Effects, Master EQ, Arpeggiator).

Performance Parts
Here you can edit the parameters of the 16 Performance Parts. Part parameters are grouped in categories and can be viewed by pressing the appropriate category 'tab' (General, Pitch, Filter, Amp, Ranges, Modes, Controllers).

System
Here you can edit some useful system parameters – these are system parameters and are not stored when you save a Performance File.

Quick Start Guide

1. Set-up Connections
When you run the Performance Editor for the first time, you should go to Setup→[MIDI Setup] and select the MIDI ports to which your Synth is connected. Press [OK] and if you have selected the correct ports, you will see a confirmation message in the status bar saying "MX49/MX61 connected". Upon connection the Editor requests the data of the currently selected Performance on the Synth.

2. Read User Voices Names
To be able to view the correct names of your user voice banks, you must go to menu Setup→[Read User Banks] and request the names of User Voices, User Drum Kits by selecting the appropriate menu command. You can re-run any of these functions later if you have altered some user voices.

3. Edit Performances
Performance data are automatically transmitted from the Synth to the Editor, so you can instantly view the Performance settings and begin tweaking. Every time you tweak a parameter, changes are made to the Synth's Performance *edit buffer*. This means that your changes, although they can be heard, they are not saved to the synth's internal memory and they will be lost if you don't store the Performance.

4. Save Performances
After you have finished tweaking a Performance, in order to keep it, you have to store it to the synth's internal memory (template or card), or even better you can store it to your hard disk as a mix file (*.mix) by using the menu command File→Save. If your Performance uses User Voices or User Drum Kits the Performance Editor saves an additional Total Librarian (*.allmx) file containing those patches using the same name with the Performance.

Menu Items

File

- **New**
  Creates a new Performance document.

- **Open**
  You can load a Performance from a mix (*.mix) file. This is a binary file which contains the system exclusive dump data of the Performance. Such a file can be created from the Performance Editor (using the "Save" function) or by manually bulk dumping a Performance from the Synth and capturing the sysex data using a software capable of capturing system exclusive messages.
  If the Performance contains User Voices this command will dump them to the synth to ensure that your Performance will sound properly! This overwrites User Voices currently stored in the same locations that's why a confirmation prompt is displayed.

- **Save**
  You can save the currently edited Performance to a sysex mix (*.mix) file using this command.
  If the Performance contains User Voices this command will automatically dump them to a Total Library (*.allmx) file and save it to the same path with the Performance file.

- **Save As**
  You can save the currently edited Performance to a sysex mix (*.mix) file using this command. You will be prompted for a new file name.

- **Close**
  Closes the opened Performance file. You will be prompted to save it if changes have been made.

- **Store**
  Stores current Performance to the synth.

- **Recent Files**
  You can quickly load one of the last eight loaded files here.

- **Exit**
  Don't press this if inspiration flows!

Edit

- **Refresh**
  If you need to receive the Performance data from the synth (i.e. if you tweaked a parameter on the Synth, without using the editor), you can use this command.

- **Reset Mix**
  You can initialize the currently edited Performance using this command.

- **GM Reset Mix**
  This command sends a General Midi (GM) Init command to the synth.

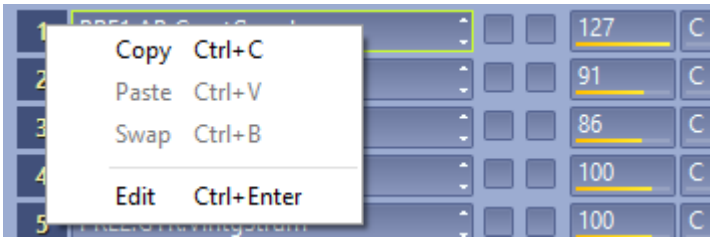
- **Part Edit**
  You can edit any of the 16 Performance parts directly using this command. If the part uses a Voice the Voice Editor will be launched to allow you edit your voice. If the part uses a Drum Kit the Drum Kit Editor will be launched to allow you edit your drum kit. Please note that when you close the Editor your changes are lost so you must save your tweaked patch to the same or to a new location before closing the Editor if you want to keep it. Then if you saved to a new location (ie it was a Preset patch) you can change the part in the Performance Editor to point to the new location.

- **Copy**
  You can copy a part of the currently edited Performance to the clipboard (one part at a time). All the parameters of the part including all arpeggio parameters will be copied to the clipboard.
  You can copy an ARP function using the ARP1-6 commands. All ARP functions settings will be copied to the clipboard.
  You can finally copy to the clipboard the System Effects settings (Reverb, Chorus) to be pasted later to another Performance.

- **Paste**
  You can paste a previously copied part of a Performance to a selectable (1-16) part of the currently edited Performance. All part parameters including arpeggiator parameters will be pasted to the selected part.
  You can paste a previously copied ARP function using the ARP1-6 commands. All ARP function settings will be copied to the selected function.
  You can also paste the System Effects settings (Reverb, Chorus) that have previously been copied from another Performance.

- **Swap**
  You can swap places of two parts using this command in conjunction with the copy command. I.e. if you want to swap parts 1 and 3, use Copy→Part1 and Swap→Part3 or Copy→Part3 and Swap→Part1!
  You can swap two ARP functions by using the Copy and Swap command. I.e. to swap ARP1 and ARP2, copy ARP1 and use the swap command for ARP2.

  Note: *The Copy, Paste, Swap and Part Edit commands are also available in the part context menus which appear when you right click on a part title.*



- **Copy Sysex Message to Clipboard**
  Whenever you tweak a synth parameter from the Performance Editor you can view the corresponding system exclusive message that is being transmitted to the Synth in the status bar of the application. Using this command, you can copy the last system exclusive message that was sent to the synth (and is showing in the status bar) to the clipboard as text, so that you can paste it to other applications.

View

- **System Settings**
  Here you can view and alter some of the most common system parameters of the synth. Keep in mind that these changes must be saved manually on the synth.

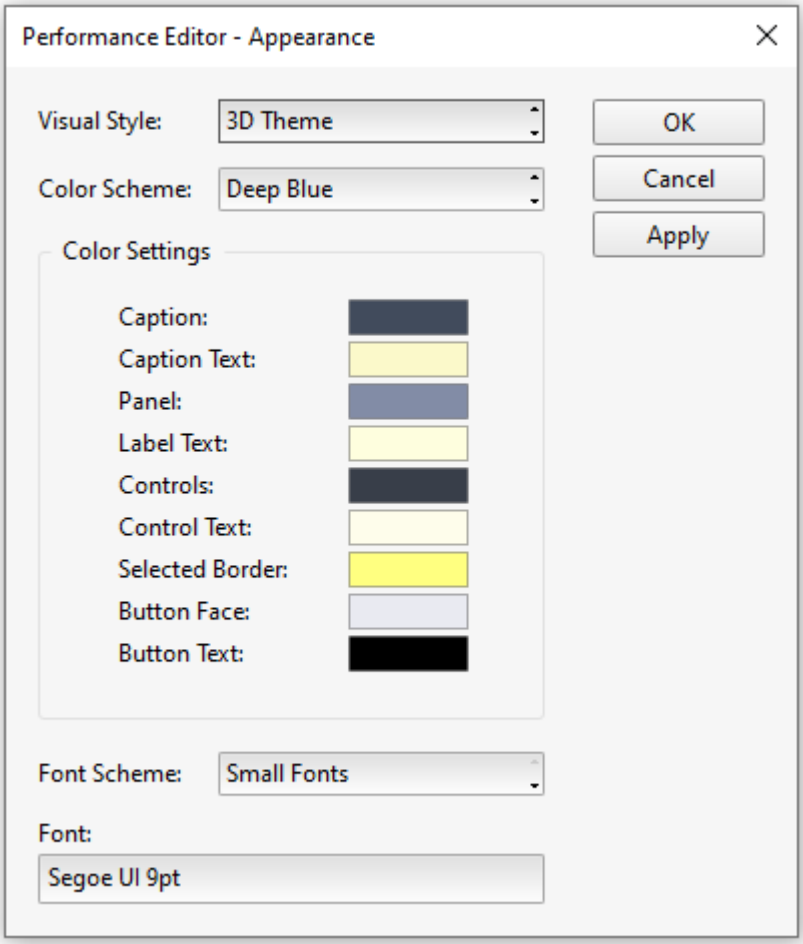
- **Keyboard**
  This command opens up a MIDI keyboard window which you can use to both play and record!



  - Playing notes
    Both the mouse and the keyboard can be used. Playing notes with the mouse supports velocity: by clicking on the lower area of the key you trigger higher velocity. Playing with the keyboard supports two series of keys from 'Z' to '/' and from 'Q' to '[', which makes 3 octaves!
  - Phrase recording
    You can record MIDI phrases played on the on-screen keyboard or on your synth or MIDI controller using this feature. Press the "record" button or the key '*' on the keyboard. The recording starts immediately when you play the first note. The recording stops if you press the "record" button again. You can hear the recorder phrase by pressing the "play" button or 'space'. You will hear your phrase in loop which means that the playback will never stop until you press the "play" button again. This is a very convenient method of auditioning your patches while you are editing them to achieve perfect results!

Setup

- **Appearance**
  Here you can change the way the program looks by customizing the visual style, the colors and the font of the user interface items. Predefined Visual Style, Color and Font schemes exist but you can always select your favorite colors and fonts.

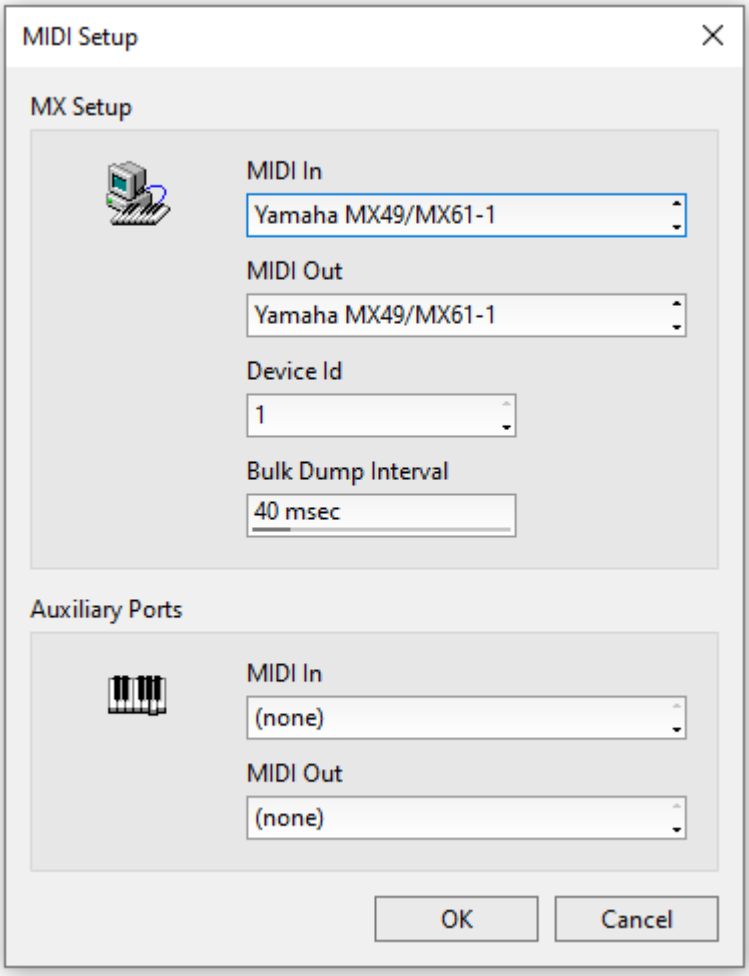


Four Visual Styles can be used:
- Flat Theme: Matches Windows 10 flat look
- Rounded Theme: Matches macOS Big Sur rounded look
- 3D Theme: Matches traditional macOS look
- Glass Theme: Matches Windows 7 Aero Glass look

Five Font Schemes exist:
- Small Fonts
- Medium Fonts
- Large Fonts
- Extra Large Fonts
- Huge Fonts

Please note that when you change the default font, all the user interface elements of the editor will be resized to match the new font size, after you restart the Application. So, if your screen resolution is huge and the editor appears relatively small you should change the font to a bigger size and/or adjust your DPI settings.

- **MIDI Setup**
  Here you have to select the MIDI-in and MIDI-out ports to which your Synth is connected. You can define the device id (usually it is 1). You can also define the interval (in milliseconds) to be added whenever multiple system exclusive messages are sent to the Synth. Finally, you can select two auxiliary ports: one additional MIDI-in port to which an external MIDI keyboard or controller is connected and one additional MIDI out port through which input data will be echoed to an externally connected Tone Generator (MIDI Thru functionality).



- **Autoconnect**
  Instead of manually defining the MIDI ports to which your Synth is connected you can use this command to let the program detect the ports automatically

- **Synchronize Voice Names**
  Here you can request the names of the Motif user voices. These names will be shown whenever you want to select a user voice and can help you search your user voices faster.

Help

- **Manual**
  Displays this document.

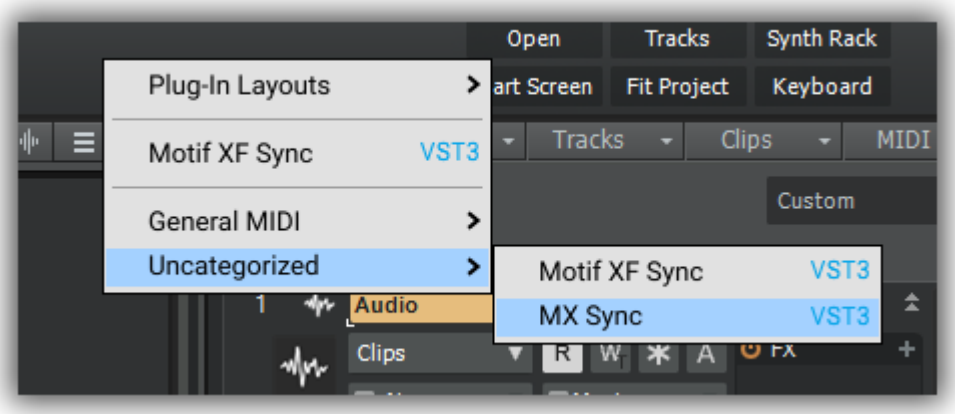
- **About**
  Shows useful information about the program. This command also checks if a new version of the program is available.

- **Product Page**
  Shows the product's page where you can download the latest version.

MX Sync Plugin

Together with the Performance Editor an MFX plugin the ***MX Sync plugin*** is distributed to help you associate your Performance Editor files with your DAW projects.

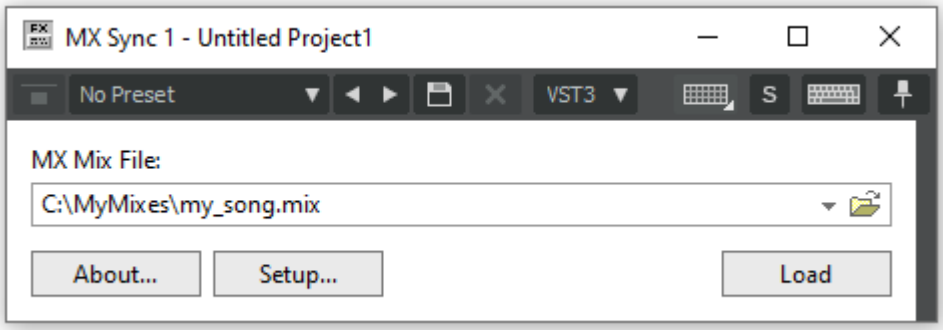
Loading the MX Sync plugin



If the Performance Editor has been properly installed, you will be able to see the MX Sync plugin in the VST3 Instruments section of your DAW. It makes sense to load it once per DAW project.

Using the MX Sync plugin

Click on the folder button of the Motif XF Sync plugin and select the Mix Editor file that you've prepared for the DAW project.



Each time you load your DAW project the MX Sync plugin does the following steps for you automatically.

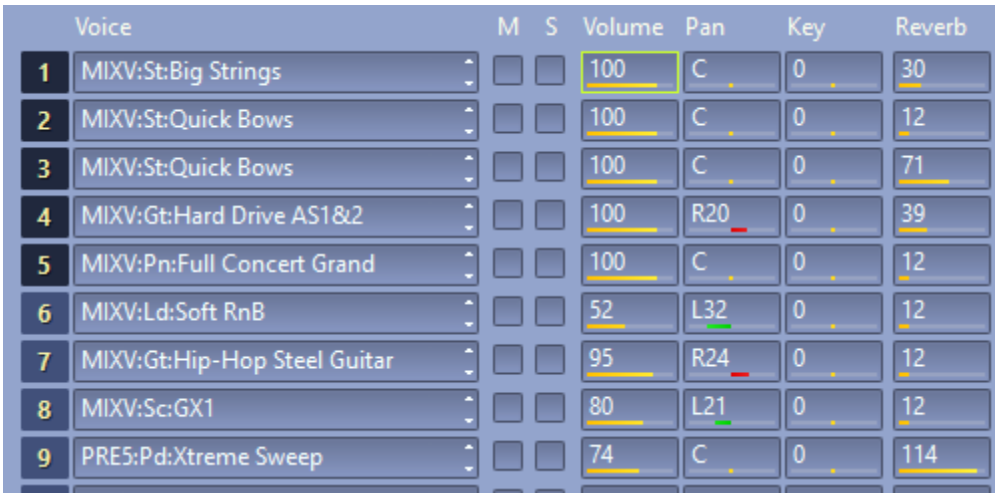
- Launches the Performance Editor (if it's not already running)
- Loads the Mix File associated with the project
- Dumps the User Voices and Drum Kits that the mix is using to the Motif

This ensures perfect synchronization of the Motif's state with your DAW projects.

Multiple Parts Selection and Editing

Performance Editor supports multiple selection for Performance Parts. You can select multiple Parts by using Ctrl+Click on the Part Number. Selected Part Numbers appear with a darker background color. To extend the selection from the current Part to the clicked Part you can use Shift+Click. By simply clicking on a Part Number, you reset the selection.

When multiple Parts are selected, changing one Parameter of one Part affects the same Parameter on all the other selected Parts. This offers a very quick way of changing multiple Parameters at once!



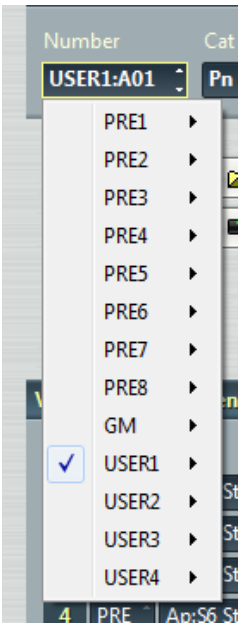
In the above picture Parts 1-5 are selected and the User is able to set the Volume Parameter of Parts 1-5 simply by changing only the Volume Parameter of Part 1.

User Interface Items (Controls)

We have tried to provide you with the most clean, simple and easy to tweak controls and we hope we have achieved perfect results. You can tweak the synth parameters using the mouse (mouse buttons and wheel) and your keyboard; you can select parameters using menus and you can see valuable information in tool-tips. Each control is specifically designed according to the type of synth parameter it is designed to control.

Patch Selectors

Patch Selectors are used for the selection of patches.
They accept keyboard and mouse input:

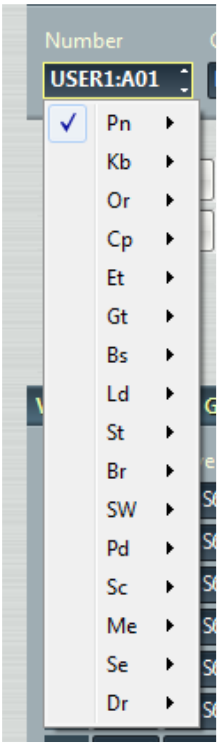


Keyboard Input

- [-], Up, Left
  These buttons select the previous program.
- [+], Down, Right
  These buttons select the next program.
- PageUp
  This button selects the previous bank.
- PageDown
  This button selects the next bank.
- Home
  This button selects the first (#1) patch of the current bank.
- End
  This button selects the last (#128) patch of the current bank.

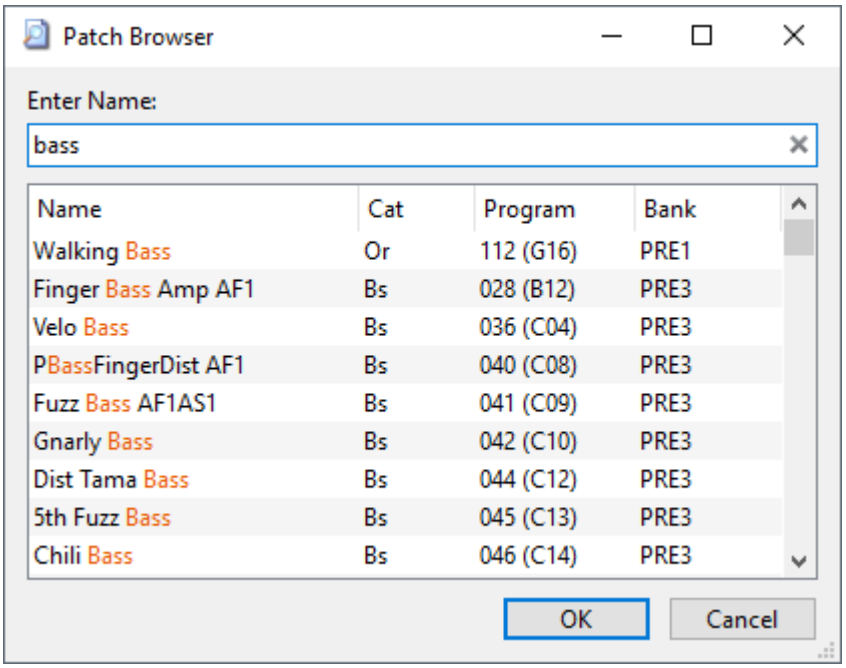
Mouse Input

- Left Click
  When you left-click on the Patch Selector, a menu appears with all the patches of the synth grouped by bank.
  The currently selected patch and bank appear checked.
- Shift + Left Click
  This displays a menu with the patches of the synth grouped By category. The currently selected patch and its category appear checked.
- Right Click
  See section "Patch Browser"
- Mouse Wheel
  Selects the previous patch if you move upwards and the next one if you move downwards.

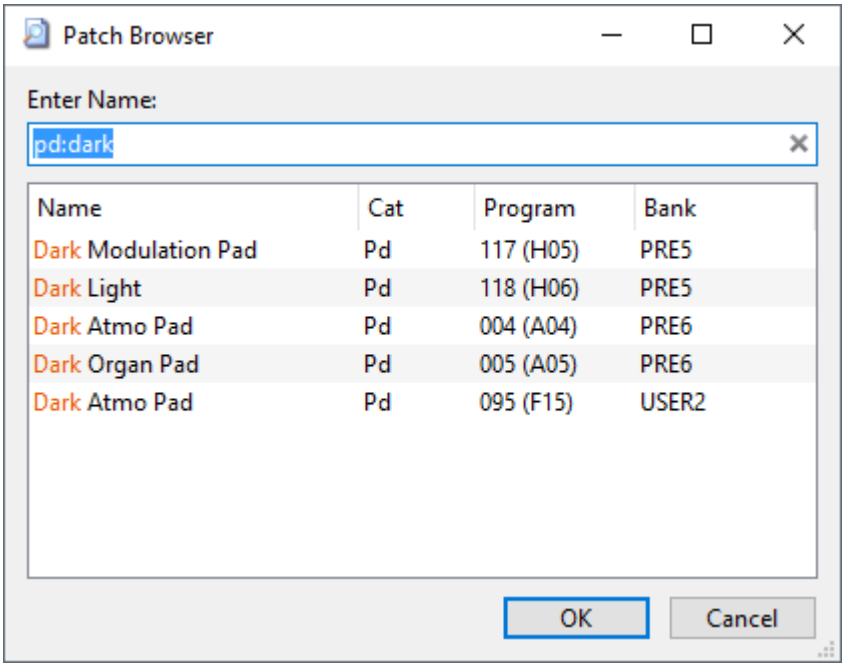


Patch Browser

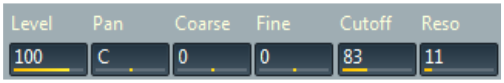
If you right-click on a Patch Selector a Patch Browser Dialog appears. Here you can quickly select a patch among the numerous patches of the Motif, by simply typing its name.



Use the ":" separator if you need to search also category names!



Sliders



A slider is the most common control of the application. It displays the value of a synth parameter (Volume, Reverb Send, Pan, etc) and it shows a bar which presents the graphical representation of the value according to its minimum and maximum values. You can tweak the synth parameter in several ways:

Keyboard Input

- [+], Up, Right
  These buttons increase the parameter by 1.
- [-], Down, Left
  These buttons decrease the parameter by 1.
- PageUp
  This button increases the parameter by ¼ of its total range.
- PageDown
  This button decreases the parameter by ¼ of its total range.
- Home
  This button sets the parameter to its maximum value.
- End
  This button sets the parameter to its minimum value.
- Numeric data entry
  Sliders can accept numeric input data from the keyboard. Digits '0' – '9' as well as '-', '+' and '.' symbols can be used which means that negative and even decimal values can be accepted.

Mouse Input

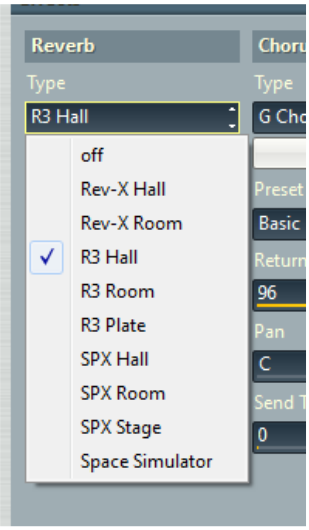
- Left Click on the value and Drag
  If you move to the right, dragging will cause increment of the value by 1 for each pixel you move. If you move to the left, dragging will cause decrement of the value by 1 for each pixel you move.
- Left Click on the bar
  The parameter will get the exact value that corresponds to the position on the bar you clicked. This is more comfortable than the previous method for parameters that have a wide range of values.
- Double Click, Left+Right Click
  The parameter will revert to its default value.
- Right Click
  See section "MIDI Keyboard Input".
- Mouse Wheel
  Increases the parameter by 1 if you move upwards and decreases it by 1 if you move downwards.

MIDI Controller Input

If a slider represents a note or a velocity value it can also accept input from a MIDI keyboard. Right click on the slider or press [F2] and its value will start blinking, indicating that the control is waiting for MIDI keyboard input. Press a key on your MIDI keyboard and the note or the velocity of the pressed key will be sent. Pressing [Escape] or left-clicking on the slider cancels its waiting state.

Furthermore some common parameters of the synth respond to MIDI Controllers (controller #10 controls Pan, #91 Reverb Send, #73 attack time, #74 Filter Cutoff etc). Sliders that are connected to such parameters respond to MIDI controller input. You can use an external MIDI controller and use its sliders or knobs to control these parameters.

Selectors



If a parameter has discrete values, a Selector is used. Its functionality is similar to that of standard combo-boxes. A selector accepts both keyboard and mouse input:

Keyboard Input

- [-], Up, Left
  These buttons select the previous value.
- [+], Down, Right
  These buttons select the next value.
- PageUp
  This button selects the value that corresponds to the previous ¼ of the total range.
- PageDown
  This button selects the value that corresponds to the next ¼ of the total range.
- Home
  This button selects the first value.
- End
  This button selects the last value.
- Text data entry
  Selectors accept text input data from the keyboard. The first parameter that matches the entered text will be selected.

Mouse Input

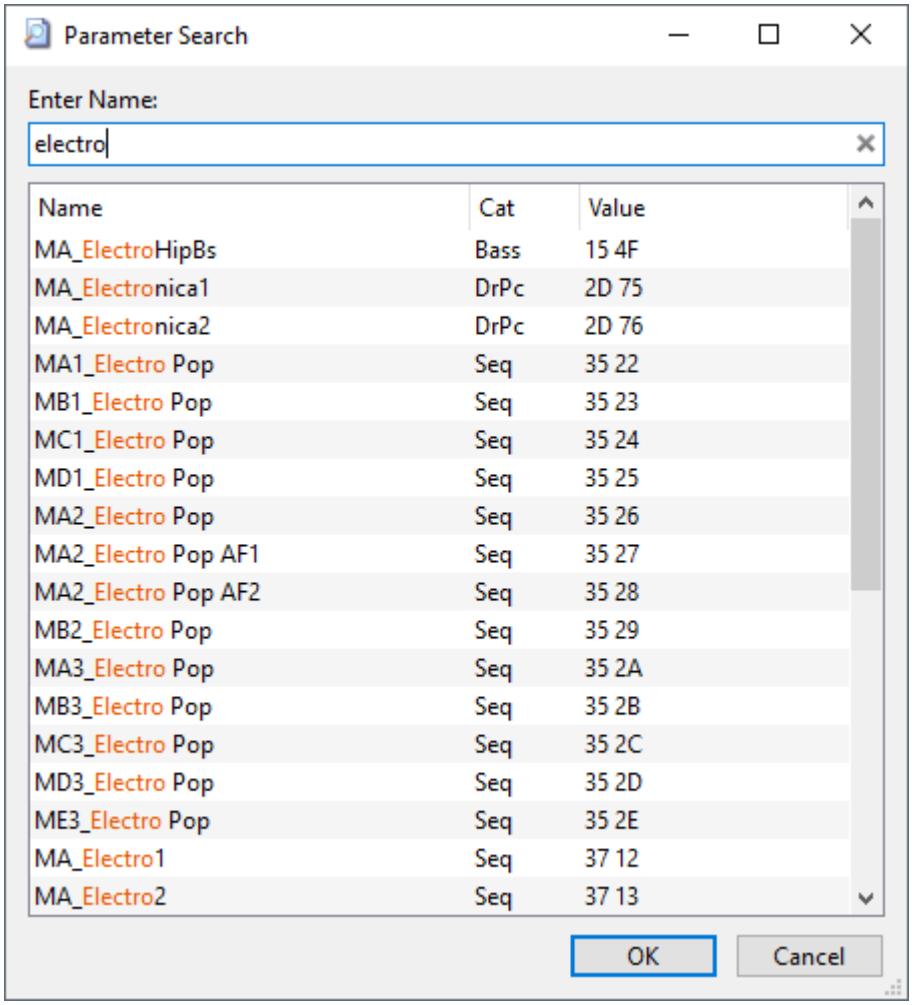
- Left Click
  If you left click on the selector a menu appears which allows you to select the desired value for the parameter. The currently selected value appears checked. If

the selector has too many discrete values (i.e. Arpeggiator type), its menu displays the parameters in groups (i.e. grouped by category for the Arpeggiator type).

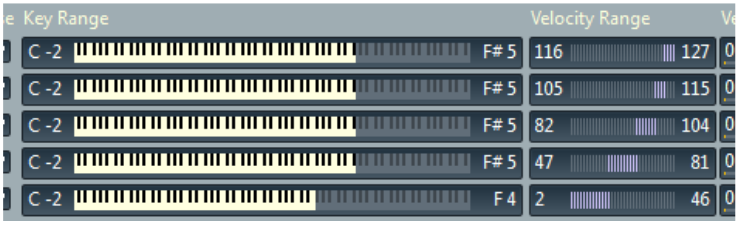
- Right Click
  See section "Parameter Search".
- Mouse Wheel
  Selects the previous value if you move upwards and the next value if you move downwards.

Parameter Search

If a selector has too many discrete values (i.e. Arpeggio Types) a search dialog appears when you right-click and allows you to search a parameter by name.
Furthermore, some selectors are connected to panels and can display a panel when you right-click on them (i.e. you can view the effects parameters if you right-click on Effect selectors).



Range Sliders



If two parameters of the synthesizer define a range (keyboard range or velocity range), a range slider is used. This is a special control because it is the only one that controls two different parameters (lower and upper limit of the corresponding range) simultaneously. Its functionality is similar to this of a slider. It responds to both keyboard and mouse input:

Keyboard Input
The keyboard buttons below control the first parameter (lower limit). They control the second parameter (higher limit) if you hold down the [Shift] key simultaneously.

- [+], Up, Right
  These buttons increase the parameter by 1.
- [-], Down, Left
  These buttons decrease the parameter by 1.
- PageUp
  This button increases the parameter by ¼ of its total range.
- PageDown
  This button decreases the parameter by ¼ of its total range.
- Home
  This button sets the parameter to its maximum value.
- End
  This button sets the parameter to its minimum value.
- F2
  See section "MIDI Keyboard Input"

Mouse Input

- Left Click on a value and Drag
  If you move to the right, dragging will cause increment of the value by 1 for each pixel you move. If you move to the left, dragging will cause decrement of the value by 1 for each pixel you move.
- Left Click on the bar and Drag
  The lower parameter will get the exact value that corresponds to the position on the bar you clicked. While you drag the mouse pointer you alter the value of the upper parameter.
- Right Click
  See section "MIDI Keyboard Input".
- Double Click
  The parameters will revert to their default values.
- Mouse Wheel
- Increases the lower parameter by 1 if you move upwards and decreases it by 1 if you move downwards. If you hold down the [Shift] key the mouse wheel controls the upper parameter.

MIDI Keyboard Input
Range slider controls which control keyboard range or velocity range also accept input from a connected MIDI keyboard. Right-click on the lower parameter (or press [F2] once) or right click on the upper parameter (or press [F2] twice) and its value will start blinking, indicating that the control is waiting for MIDI keyboard input. Press a key on your MIDI keyboard and the note or the velocity of the pressed key will be sent. Pressing [Escape] or left-clicking on the range-slider cancels its waiting state. The use of a MIDI keyboard is a very comfortable way of defining keyboard splits or velocity ranges!

Text Editors

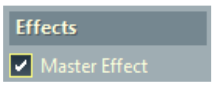


To change a patch's name text editors are used. By default the text editor control is in view-only mode. If you left-click on the editor control, it sets itself to edit mode and you can type a name. If you press [Enter] while in edit mode or click anywhere outside the control, it reverts to view-only mode and it sends the typed input to the synthesizer.

Tempo Editors

The Tempo Editor is actually a slider but with the extra support of "Tap-Tempo". The [Enter] key is used for tempo tapping and each tap represents quarter notes. The tempo value is calculated as an average from the first time you tapped and the last one so as to be as close as possible to the tempo you want to achieve. If you need to restart tapping and the calculation of the tempo, just press any other key instead of [Enter].

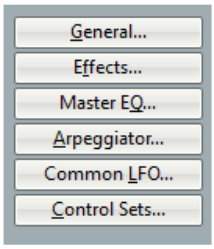
Check Buttons



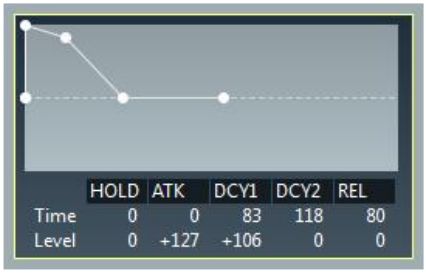
If a synth parameter has only two values (on/off), a check button is used. Its behavior is exactly the same to that of standard check-boxes. If you left click on it, or press space, you toggle the on/off state.

Buttons

Buttons can be used to display additional panels. Press [Space] or click on them to open a panel. Please note the additional panels of the editors are not modal, so you don't need to close them in order to tweak values of other panels. Finally, panels remember their position, so if you close them and open them again they will always show up in the same position on-screen.



Envelope Editors



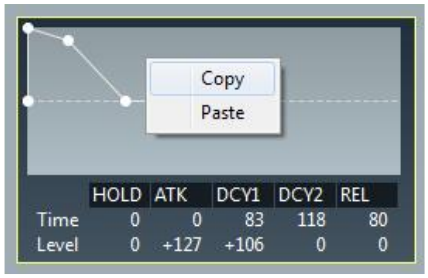
Envelope Editors can be used to configure the envelope generators of the Synth. (Pitch, Filter, Amplitude Envelope Generators). You can tweak the envelope parameters using both the keyboard and the mouse.

Keyboard Input

- Space
  This button selects the next node of the envelope.
- Down
  This button decreases the selected node's Level parameter by 1.
- Up
  This button increases the selected node's Level parameter by 1.
- Left
  This button decreases the selected node's Time parameter by 1.
- Right
  This button increases the selected node's Time parameter by 1.
- PageDown
  This button decreases the selected node's Level parameter by 10.
- PageUp
  This button increases the selected node's Level parameter by 10.

Mouse Input

- Left Click on a node and Drag
  This movement freely defines both the Level and Time parameters of the selected node according to your movements.
- Double Click
  Sets the Time and Level parameters of the node to their default values
- Right Click
  Opens the context sensitive menu of the envelope. Copy and Paste functions are supported which means you can transfer the settings of an entire envelope quickly to other envelopes!



Keyboard Shortcuts

Ctrl + Tab
Navigates to next panel

Ctrl + Shift + Tab
Navigates to previous panel

Alt + (Number)
Selects specific tab of a tabbed panel

Ctrl + (Number)
Navigates to a specific part (1-10)

Ctrl + Shift + (1..6)
Navigates to a specific part (11-16)

Ctrl + Up
Selects previous part in a multi part panel

Ctrl + Down
Selects next part in a multi part panel

Ctrl + Left
Selects previous control of selected part

Ctrl + Right
Selects next control of selected part

Ctrl + Home
Selects first control of selected part

Ctrl + End
Selects last control of selected part

F5
Receive from Synth

F6
Store Multi

F7
Local Control on/off

Contact Information

For any suggestions, comments, requests, bug report please feel free to contact me at

info@jmelas.gr

For updates and news please visit

http://www.jmelas.gr/motif

Sincerely,
John Melas